STAKEHOLDER REPORT · 12 NOVEMBER 2026

Governed AI delivery: how the platform compares, and where the market stands

Part 1 compares the Unified Product Delivery Platform with spec-driven tools and IDE-only working, role by role. Part 2 reviews the state of AI in software and product delivery, with a focus on Canadian banks and a region-by-region view.

Summary Part 1: Three approaches Part 2: State of maturity Canada Regions What it means Method and limits

How to read the numbers. Persona scores and maturity levels are our own estimates. Survey and bank figures come from published summaries and press coverage of the named sources: the researchers could not open the primary pages in this environment. Two key facts were re-checked by search (the Evident ranking and the OSFI dates). Verify any figure before it is quoted externally.

Summary

74 / 56 / 53
Total persona score out of 108: this platform, spec-driven tools, IDE only.

90% vs 6.6%
Developers who use AI at work, against those who would trust it with an important decision.

Level 1.5
Where Canadian banks sit on a 0 to 4 scale of AI in software delivery (our estimate).

No bank at level 3
No bank in any region has publicly described governed, multi-stage agentic delivery with named approvers.

- **The platform is the best fit for non-developer roles.** It leads for the product owner, architect, release manager, administrator and auditor, mainly on evidence and on understanding what the AI did.
- **Developers are better served by tools in their editor.** Spec Kit and IDE agents are free or already licensed, live in the repository and have a faster loop. The platform's copy-and-paste hand-off costs it points.

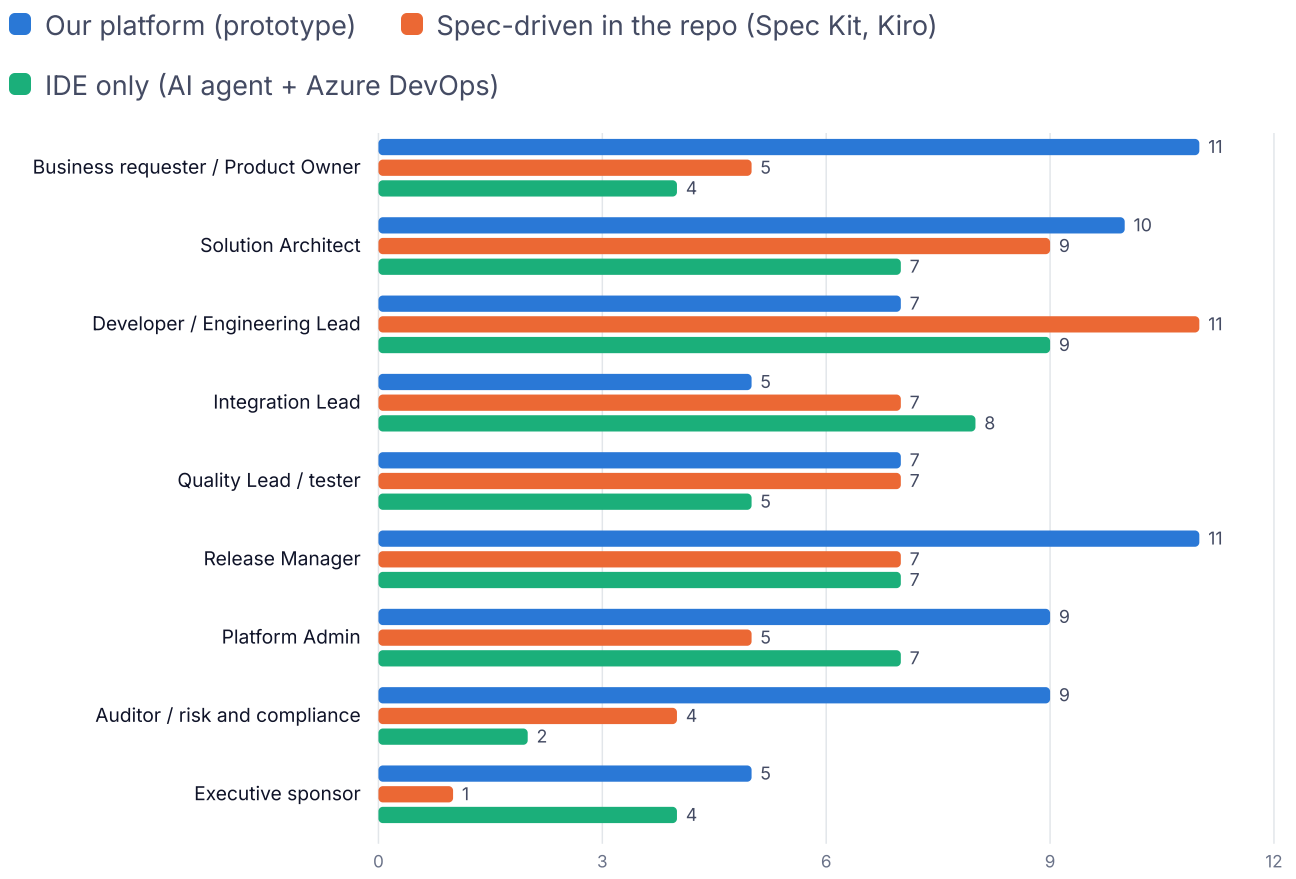
- **The platform adds waits.** A one-field change needs 8 waits for a person, against 6 for the alternatives in a regulated organisation and 1 in a small team. A fast path for low-risk changes is the first priority.
- **The market is strong on coding assistants and weak on governance.** Individual output is up, but review time, bugs and incidents are up too. Review is the bottleneck.
- **Canada's regulator is explicit.** OSFI published a bulletin on generative and agentic AI on 13 July 2026, and Guideline E-23 on model risk takes effect on 1 May 2027.

PART 1

Three ways to run AI-assisted delivery

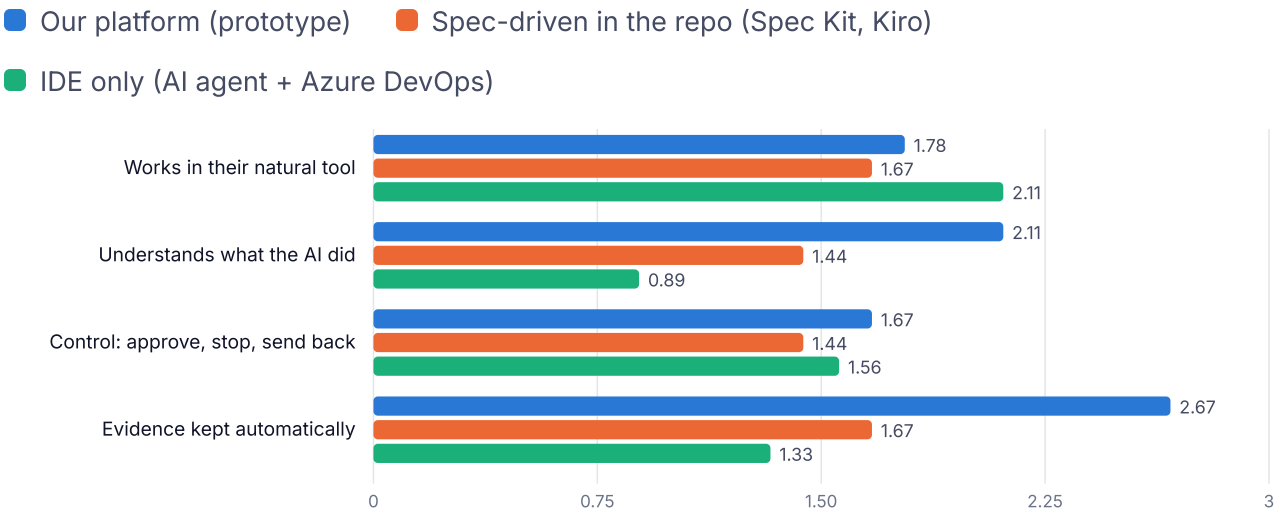
A. This platform (prototype): a business request goes through eight gated stages with named approvers and one evidence trail; the Developer Agent runs standalone in VS Code. **B. Spec-driven in the repo**: GitHub Spec Kit and AWS Kiro, where developers write and approve markdown specifications next to the code. **C. IDE only**: everyone works from VS Code with an AI coding agent, plus Azure DevOps or GitHub for pull requests and pipelines.

Score by role, out of 12



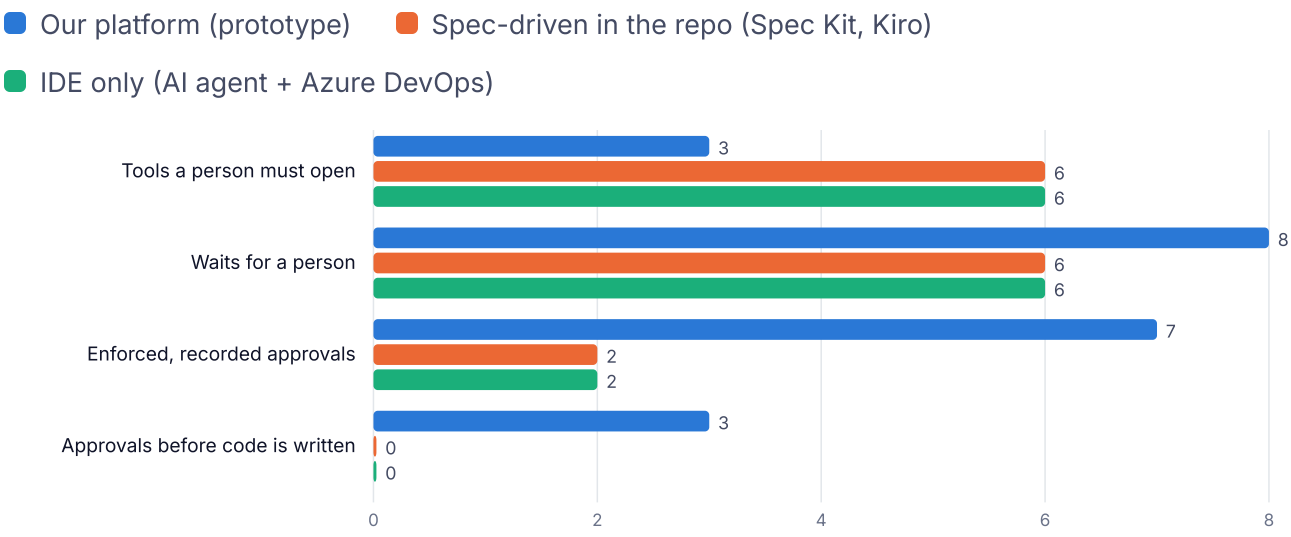
Four criteria, 0 to 3 each: works in their natural tool, understands what the AI did, control (approve, stop, send back), evidence kept automatically. Our assessment; the platform is scored as a prototype, the other two as shipping products. No users were observed or timed.

Average by criterion, 0 to 3



The platform leads on evidence and on explaining the AI's work. IDE-only working leads on staying in the person's natural tool.

One small change, walked through all three



The change: block values above 310 on one form. Counts are for a regulated organisation with tester and release roles. In a small team, approaches B and C need 2 tools, 1 wait and 1 recorded approval. Elapsed time was not measured.

What the experience is like

This platform

- Non-developers work in a browser, in plain language, and never open a repository.
- Status, who holds the work and what happens next are always visible.
- Every approval is explained by "How the agent did this" and recorded.
- Cost: more gates and more waiting; developers leave their editor to pick up work.

Spec-driven in the repo

- Natural for developers: specifications are files next to the code.
- Product owners and auditors must read markdown in a repository or rely on a developer.
- Published reviews describe long specifications that are heavier to review than the code.
- Approval is a pull-request review; nothing is approved before code exists.

IDE only

- Fastest loop for a developer, with no new process to learn.
- Other roles see only tickets and pull requests, not what the AI did or why.
- Evidence is spread across the editor, the repository and the pipeline.
- Works well for small teams and developer-only changes.

Improvements this comparison led to

Improvement	Why	Status
Approval screens for the Integration Lead and Quality Lead, with send-back notes; both added to "View as"	They had permissions but no screen to approve on	Done in the prototype
"How the agent did this" for the Impact and Integrate stages	The panel showed design-stage content for those stages	Done in the prototype
Fast path for low-risk changes and a bug-fix request type	8 waits for a one-field change	Next
Direct hand-off to the VS Code agent in place of copy and paste	The developer's biggest loss against B and C	Next
Read-only copy of the approved specification in the pull request	Developers review where the code is	Next
Insights view for the executive sponsor	No approach serves this role today	Later

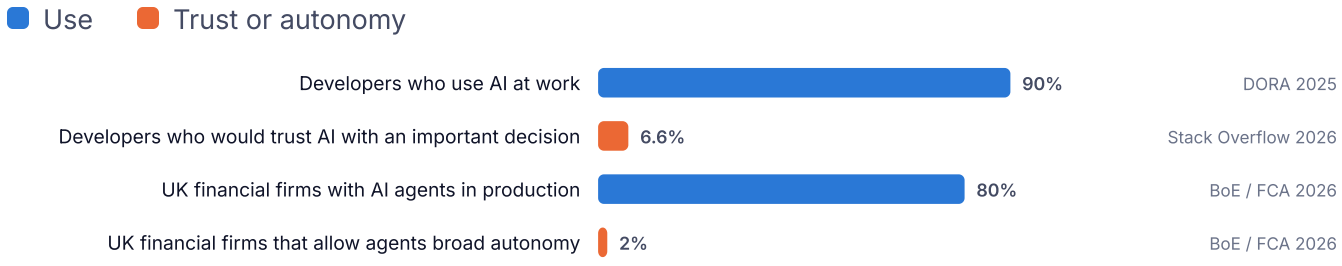
PART 2

State of AI maturity in software and product delivery

A five-level scale

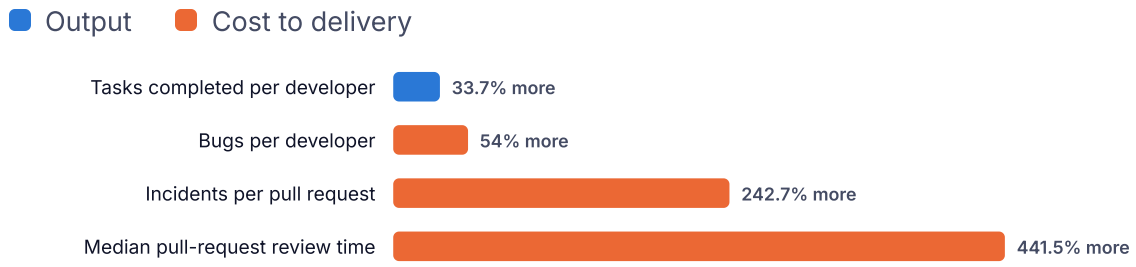
Level	Name	Who does the work, who decides	Public evidence at banks
L0	None or unsanctioned	People do everything; any AI use is individual	Nothing disclosed, or bans
L1	Assisted coding in the IDE	The developer writes; AI suggests	"N developers on a coding assistant"
L2	Task agents that open pull requests	An agent completes a bounded task; a developer reviews	Agent adoption rates, AI share of code
L3	Governed multi-stage delivery with human gates	Agents draft across stages; named people approve at gates	Not found at any bank. This platform's target.
L4	Policy-driven autonomous delivery	A versioned policy approves low-risk change	Not found at any bank

Use is near universal; trust is not



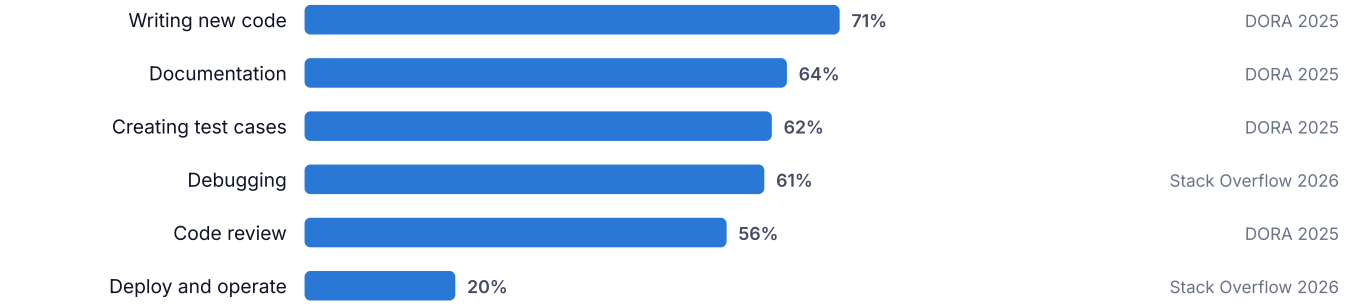
Sources: Google DORA 2025; Stack Overflow Developer Survey 2026; Bank of England and FCA AI survey 2026. Different surveys and bases, shown side by side for shape only.

Individual output is up; delivery as a whole is strained



Source: Faros AI 2026, a vendor's telemetry study of about 22,000 developers, via secondary coverage. Controlled studies are mixed: one small trial (METR, 2025) found experienced developers 19% slower with AI, and others found tasks completed 21% to 26% faster.

Where in the lifecycle AI is used



Percent of respondents; DORA 2025 and Stack Overflow 2026, different bases. No survey figure was found for requirements or design, which is where this platform starts.

Canada

Evident AI Index for Banks 2026

Rank of 50	Bank	Country
1	JPMorgan Chase	US
2	Capital One	US
3	RBC	Canada
4	Commonwealth Bank	Australia
10	TD	Canada
11	HSBC	UK
20	BMO	Canada
21	CIBC	Canada
25	DBS	Singapore
30	Scotiabank	Canada

Published 6 Oct 2026. Selected banks; ranks via Evident and press coverage. The index measures overall AI maturity, not software delivery.

Regulation that shapes delivery

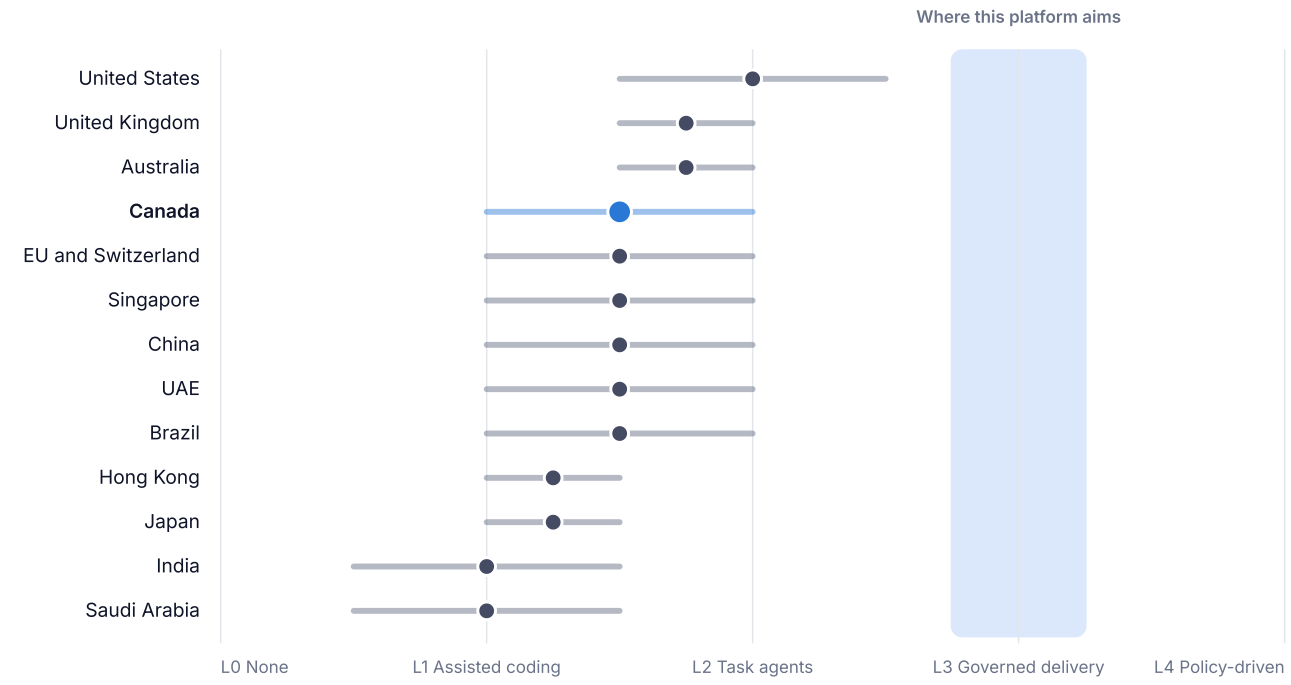
- **13 July 2026:** OSFI bulletin on generative and agentic AI, covering technology, cyber security and operational resilience, including software development.
- **1 May 2027:** OSFI Guideline E-23 on model risk takes effect and covers AI models.
- Existing guidelines B-13 (technology and cyber risk) and B-10 (third-party risk) already apply to change control and to vendors.
- There is no federal AI statute in force, so OSFI guidance is what binds.

Placement from public evidence only

Institution	Level (range)	Confidence	Basis reported in public sources
RBC	1.5 (1 to 2)	Medium	Central platform with AI code generation for its developers; no agent adoption rate or gated workflow disclosed
TD	1.5 (1 to 2)	Medium	Coding assistant enabled for all engineers, with reported adoption and throughput gains
Scotiabank	1.5 (1 to 2)	Medium	Its own coding assistant; investment in agent governance
CIBC	1.0 (1 to 1.5)	Medium	Coding assistant for part of its developers
BMO	1.0 (1 to 1.5)	Medium	Coding assistant roll-out with a stated productivity target
National Bank	1.0 (0.5 to 1.5)	Low	Job postings only
Manulife, Sun Life	1.5 (1 to 2)	Low	Statements on assisted and agentic coding; no method or adoption rate

Our estimate. A bank may be further ahead internally than it has disclosed; differences of 0.25 are not significant. Details and sources per institution are in the full research file.

Region by region



Dot: our estimate of where most bank engineering work sits. Line: plausible range. Confidence is medium for the US, UK, Australia, Canada and the EU, and low elsewhere.

- **United States (about 2.0):** the leading banks show the most public evidence of coding agents in daily engineering work. Model-risk guidance leaves generative and agentic AI out of scope.
- **United Kingdom and Australia (about 1.75):** wide use of assistants and some agent programmes; UK firms keep agents on a short leash, with 2% allowing broad autonomy.
- **European Union (about 1.5):** the AI Act and DORA put change control and evidence first.
- **Asia-Pacific, Middle East, Latin America (1.0 to 1.5):** evidence is thinner and confidence is low.

What it means for a Canadian bank

- **The platform targets a level no bank has publicly reached.** There is no peer to copy, so plan a staged pilot with its own baseline.
- **It lines up with what OSFI asks for.** Map each gate and evidence record to the expectation it meets, and put the platform's own agents in the model inventory before May 2027.

- **Eight gates will collide with the review bottleneck** unless gates are risk-tiered from day one.
- **The value is at the two ends of the lifecycle**, the business request and the release evidence. Banks already have coding tools.
- **Keeping the developer agent in VS Code fits** the tools Canadian banks have disclosed, but the hand-off must be tracked.
- **Measure delivery outcomes** (lead time, change failure rate, review wait, send-back rate) and expect a dip in the first months.
- **Treat the vendor and model providers as critical third parties** and plan where prompts and code are processed.

Method and limits

- Part 1 is an assessment by an analyst reading the prototype and public documentation of Spec Kit, Kiro and IDE agents. No users were observed.
- Part 2 rests on about 95 web searches on 12 November 2026. No primary page could be opened, so every figure comes from a search excerpt or secondary coverage.
- Bank figures are self-reported and not comparable with each other. Vendor telemetry studies come from companies that sell a remedy for the problem they measure.
- Not found: any survey figure for AI use in requirements or design; Evident point scores; the exact wording of OSFI's bulletin on AI-generated code.

Main sources

- Google DORA: AI-assisted software development
- Stack Overflow Developer Survey 2026
- Bank of England and FCA: AI in UK financial services 2026
- Faros AI 2026 telemetry study
- Evident AI Index for Banks and Advisor.ca coverage
- OSFI bulletin on generative and agentic AI and Guideline E-23
- GitHub Spec Kit

The full research files, with every source tagged by type, are in the project repository under app/review/panel: compare.md and maturity.md.